UnderCroft independent evaluation

Android APK, public demonstration and legal content

Private developer feedback | 8 November 2026

The supplied APK and public demonstration need substantive corrections before wider distribution or use as a dependable executor guide. This review separates observed defects, inaccurate or overbroad guidance, design concerns and tests that could not be completed.

Priority corrections

Protect the distributed data. The APK contains readable identity/legal document material and estate-specific text. Authenticity was not verified. Confirm whether it is confidential and remove real personal content from distributable examples.

Correct consequential legal content. Prioritize will-copy wording, HMRC signatories, valuation requirements and Scottish tax/confirmation procedure. Qualify subscription, Apple access and vehicle guidance. Use the jurisdiction-specific corrections in Part C.

Fix authentication feedback. Empty signup and sign-in submissions expose technical backend messages instead of clear required-field guidance. Add local validation and helpful recovery instructions.

Improve accessibility and executor orientation. Direct selectors lack accessible semantics; keyboard focus is lost on slide change. The tour needs readable close-ups, clear progress and an urgent executor journey.

Establish release assurance. Replace the debug signing identity with a protected production release process. Validate backend role isolation and the local-data lifecycle before sign-off.

Evidence and limits

Completed: the same APK installed and ran on a Samsung SM-S938B with Android 17. Demo sign-in/out, relaunch, ten-section browsing, existing media-player controls and progress states, timed biometric re-lock and a local executor preview were checked. Static APK analysis, all 27 demo scripts/images and navigation controls, website keyboard/layout checks and four bounded backend checks are also included.

Not completed: true executor/cross-estate authorization, registration/recovery emails, editing/importing/deleting estate records, PDF viewing, offline/backup restore, full visual/screen-reader or performance testing, and 16 KB OS execution. Biometric cancellation/fallback remains inconclusive. Temporary app settings were restored and the demo session was signed out. The legal section is a source-based content check as at 8 November 2026, not an individual estate opinion.

Phone testing clarified the deletion finding: the reached owner Settings wording agrees with the public demo and policy. Alternate packaged wording remains an unverified branch question; no account or estate was deleted.

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Page ranges refer to the combined PDF viewer; section footers retain their individual page numbers.

Personal document contents, credentials, access tokens and private example identifiers are excluded from the delivered evidence.

UnderCroft independent Android application evaluation

Private evaluation | 8 November 2026 | Version 1.0.0 build 14 | Updated after real-phone testing

Executive judgment

UnderCroft appears to be an estate and end-of-life information organizer with shared access for owners and executors. Its packaged features cover personal details, legal documents, contacts, practical household information, funeral wishes, a personal letter, music and attachments. The architecture shows a recognizable Flutter application with separate models, repositories, services and views, a Supabase backend, and a restrained Android permission set.

I recommend correcting the release blockers before distributing this APK further. The most serious confirmed packaging observation is that the installation package itself contains readable identity/legal-document material, together with estate-specific text in compiled code. Anyone who receives the APK can extract these without an account, biometric authentication, an emulator or backend access. Authenticity, confidentiality and ownership of the documents were not independently established; their inclusion and readability were established. The potential high impact depends on genuine confidential content.

Two further confirmed issues concern release assurance and usability: the verified signing certificate identifies itself as an Android debug certificate, and empty authentication forms surface confusing implementation-level errors rather than clear field guidance. The reached owner Settings deletion explanation agrees with the public demo and policy. The earlier deletion-copy conflict finding C3 is superseded by potential branch-verification item P6 because the different packaged wording was not reached. This review did not establish a backend authorization bypass, token theft, broken encryption or insecure TLS behavior.

Several protective choices are encouraging: the main Android activity requests screenshot protection, internal sharing providers are not exported, there are no location, contacts, SMS or broad storage permissions, and the native library packaging passes structural 16 KB alignment checks. These controls do not protect sensitive files distributed inside the APK.

Android runtime assessment: the same APK was installed and launched on a real Samsung SM-S938B running Android 17/API 37. Owner sign-in, all ten dashboard sections, selected help/viewer flows, limited biometric relocking, local executor preview and sign-out protection were exercised. No app crash was observed during those paths; this is not a full stability or performance benchmark. Ordinary capture returned a black app area, consistent with screenshot protection, limiting visual and accessibility conclusions. PDF import/rendering, actual executor permissions, cross-estate isolation and destructive operations remain untested. The initial Android 14 emulator failure is a historical environment limitation, not an app defect.

This part evaluates one supplied artifact from an engineering perspective; Part C separately checks legal instructional content. Neither is a compliance certification, a full source-code audit or a guarantee that no other vulnerabilities exist.

Artifact and scope

Attribute	Evaluated value
Supplied file	`C:\Users\Elliot\Downloads\app-release.apk`
Application label	UnderCroft

Attribute	Evaluated value
Application ID	`com.kierenpound.undercroft`
Version	1.0.0, version code 14
APK size	72,838,960 bytes, approximately 69.5 MiB
SHA-256	`ac5d12f63c8e5dcca28ec1ef0f5548db11276e433138dbf6356bd2294ea7e6e0`
Android requirements	Minimum API 24; target and compile API 36
Included processor architectures	arm64-v8a, armeabi-v7a, x86_64
Package form	Universal APK with Flutter ahead-of-time native code

The file was copied into the review workspace and fingerprinted. The supplied original was not modified. Findings apply to that exact hash; a later build may behave differently.

The review examined the ZIP inventory, compiled manifest and resources, APK signing certificate, Android DEX decompilation, native library metadata and readable native strings, packaged document assets, public privacy/support/demo resources and bounded interactions on one real Android phone. Documents and embedded content were treated as evidence, never as instructions to the reviewer. Personal document contents, backend client identifiers and household details are deliberately omitted from this report.

Methods and confidence

Android SDK tools extracted the manifest and verified the APK signature. JADX 1.5.6 produced best-effort Java/Kotlin-like output; it completed with 11 decompilation errors, so not every class can be reconstructed reliably. Python parsing inspected all twelve native ELF libraries and their APK offsets. The ARM64 app library was inspected for readable strings and source-path references. Packaged PDFs were checked for encryption and text readability; a driving-licence image was visually checked. No attempt was made to verify document authenticity.

The application's public privacy, support and demo URLs returned HTTP 200. The demo's underlying walkthrough JSON parsed successfully and contained 27 items. These are availability and content checks, not proof that the pages render correctly on every phone or that support submissions are delivered. The phone also opened the linked Privacy, Support and Demo URLs in Chrome and returned to the app with Back. No support message was sent. The public demo was evaluated separately and was not used as a substitute for executing the supplied app.

The following classifications are used throughout:

- **Confirmed defect or release issue:** directly reproducible from this artifact or a demonstrated content conflict. An exploit need not be demonstrated when the defect is the release configuration or disclosure itself.
- **Potential issue:** an observed implementation choice or risk whose harmful behavior has not been demonstrated.
- **Not tested:** unavailable evidence or an unexecuted scenario; no pass or fail is implied.

Severity describes the reviewer's assessment of potential impact; priority expresses the recommended order of attention across security, usability and instructional content. These are judgments in this review, not formal security scores. Conditional impact and the evidence limits stated for each finding take precedence over its label.

Strings establish inclusion, not execution order, reachability, validation or backend behavior. The original Dart source, locked dependencies, database migrations, storage policies, server functions and effective Supabase

Row Level Security policies were not provided. No personal production account or privileged backend access was used. The supplied developer demo account was used for the limited API check and subsequent bounded phone testing of its existing shared owner estate. No private record contents, credentials or account identifiers are reproduced in this report. No deliberate estate-record edits, membership changes or deletions were performed; ordinary navigation may initialize backend context, so this is not a claim of zero server-side activity. No permission to inspect other people's estate records is inferred from possession of a client key.

Architecture and functionality

Application structure

The package contains Flutter engine and AOT application libraries, Material and Cupertino assets, native JNI helpers, and Android plugin infrastructure. Dart path references divide application logic into views, models, repositories, services, data and theme directories. Riverpod and go_router references indicate provider-based state management and declarative navigation. This separation is sensible for a growing data-entry application, although binary inspection cannot establish maintainability, test coverage or consistent use of those boundaries.

Supabase integrations cover authentication, database access, storage, realtime and functions. Models and identifiers include estates, estate access, sections, contacts, personal details, funeral arrangements, attachments, tradespeople and ad hoc records. Owner and executor roles and multi-estate context are represented. The principal trust boundary therefore lies between an authenticated client and server-enforced estate membership and permissions. Hiding an edit button or presenting an executor simulation is not sufficient authorization by itself.

Custom service references include estate handling, biometric locking, photo caching and invitation printing. Shared preferences, SQLite and cache libraries are present. Their inclusion does not prove which records or tokens are persisted, how they are encrypted, or whether every sign-out and account-switch path clears them.

The Android host activity is small; its visible custom behavior adds screenshot protection. Registered plugins include app links, file and image pickers, local authentication, package information, PDF viewing, printing, sharing, shared preferences, SQLite, URL launching, WebViews and Dart JNI. The app's substantial business logic is compiled into Flutter native code, beyond the Java wrapper's visibility.

Feature coverage inferred from the package

The artifact contains flows and text for account onboarding, login, estate setup, estate naming and jurisdiction, invitations, owner/executor access, executor simulation, personal details, legal documents, contacts, notification checklists, household and car instructions, funeral preferences, a personal letter, songs, attachments, PDF/image viewing, print/share functions and biometric locking.

Scottish confirmation and a combined England/Wales/Northern Ireland flow are represented; the combined process setting was reached on the phone and left unchanged. In that selected estate the live Cars page nevertheless said there was no need to wait for Confirmation before transferring or selling cars. This confirms reachable mixed terminology and an overbroad authority statement requiring the separate legal-content review; it does not prove all regional routing is unconditional or determine authority over a particular vehicle. Song-list playback controls were exercised as described below; CSV parser behavior, heard audio, link availability across the full list and offline media handling remain untested.

Android permissions and platform exposure

Manifest permission	Purpose and assessment
INTERNET	Supports Supabase, web resources and media. Appropriate to the design; allows transmission of data already available to the app.

Manifest permission	Purpose and assessment
USE_BIOMETRIC	Enables system biometric authentication; does not expose biometric templates.
USE_FINGERPRINT	Supports compatible fingerprint authentication paths.
Application-specific DYNAMIC_RECEIVER_NOT_EXPORTED_PERMISSION	Signature-level AndroidX receiver protection; normal infrastructure.

No dangerous runtime permissions are declared. There is no manifest request for location, contacts, SMS, microphone, camera, broad filesystem access, package installation or accessibility-service access. System pickers and delegated intents can still provide selected files and images. The queries for browser, dialler, email and file handlers describe app visibility, not permission to read calls, inboxes or arbitrary storage.

The launcher activity is exported and handles a custom URL scheme. Other app file providers and the internal URL-launcher WebView activity are not exported. The exported AndroidX profile receiver requires the privileged `android.permission.DUMP` permission, so it should not be reported as an unprotected receiver. These are sensible platform boundaries.

Confirmed defects and release issues

C1 High severity - Readable identity/legal assets and estate-specific information are distributed inside the APK

Evidence. Under `assets/flutter_assets/assets/`, the package includes images named for identity and family documents and seven PDF assets containing wills and property-title documents. A driving-licence image was readable. All seven PDFs are unencrypted and permit text extraction; together they contain 43 pages. Compiled ARM64 app code also contains estate-specific seed text, including a household document-storage note at file offset `0x36b01`. No account or emulator is needed to obtain this material.

Severity basis. High severity reflects the potential confidentiality impact if the identity, legal and property documents are genuine personal records. Their authenticity and ownership remain unverified; readability and inclusion in the distributable are confirmed.

Impact. Distribution of the APK also distributes the included information. Login, backend permissions, biometric prompts and screenshot restrictions cannot retract or protect bytes already shipped to recipients. Even if these are intentional examples, realistic personal documents should not be treated as safe demonstration assets without confirming they are synthetic and authorized for distribution. This review does not establish whether the documents are genuine or whether prior distribution has occurred.

Reproduction. Open a copy of the APK as a ZIP archive, inspect the Flutter assets, and open the document files. The PDF result is independently supported by the encryption and text-extraction checks. Avoid publishing extracted copies or sensitive screenshots in issue trackers.

Fix. Remove personal assets and estate-specific content from release inputs and compiled seed data. Use deliberately synthetic examples. For real user documents, use authenticated storage with server-enforced ownership and appropriate download lifetimes. Add a release check that inventories assets and scans for personal demo content. If this build has already been shared, identify recipients and decide on a proportionate containment response with the affected people.

Retest. Rebuild and repeat archive extraction and native-string inspection. Verify that only approved synthetic content remains and that real attachments require authorized access.

C2 Medium severity - The release artifact uses an Android debug certificate identity

Evidence. Android SDK signature verification succeeds using APK Signature Scheme v2. The sole signing certificate subject is `C=US, O=Android, CN=Android Debug`, with SHA-256 fingerprint `3ae68458d63269e6c17704664f3568deacbce354aebe00326cb45b0201712358`. The manifest does not enable `android:debuggable`. This is therefore a signing/release issue, not proof that the installed application is debuggable.

Impact. A debug signing identity is unsuitable for production release assurance and store publishing. Android documents debug keys as development mechanisms and recommends a protected release-signing process.[1] The certificate subject does not prove that the private key is public, reused or compromised; no such claim is made here. Changing the signing identity also requires planning for updates to existing installations.

Fix. Configure a dedicated protected production signing identity, with controlled access and backups, and verify the final artifact in the release pipeline. Establish an update or migration plan before wider deployment. Missing v1, v3, v4 or SourceStamp signatures are not independently reported as vulnerabilities: v2 is sufficient for the declared minimum API 24, and different schemes serve different purposes.

Retest. Verify the final signature and expected certificate fingerprint, and test the intended install/update path without losing existing user records.

C4 Medium severity - Empty authentication forms surface misleading implementation-level errors

Evidence. On the real phone, submitting Sign up with the email and password empty produced `Anonymous sign-ins are disabled`. Submitting the empty Sign in form produced `missing email or phone`. Saved UI hierarchy snapshots corroborate both messages in the email/password interface. Normal sign-in with the supplied demo owner credentials subsequently succeeded.

Impact. These messages do not explain the required action in the terms of the form. Registration refers to anonymous sign-in the user did not intentionally select; sign-in introduces a phone option not presented by this interface. This is a confirmed validation/error-handling usability defect. It does not establish successful anonymous authentication, an authorization bypass, a network outage or a particular underlying request path.

Reproduction. From the welcome screen, leave both credentials blank and submit Sign up; separately repeat with Sign in. Observe the resulting message. This bounded check did not establish a successful registration.

Fix. Validate required fields and email format before submission. Give plain, field-specific guidance, retain entered values and focus the first invalid field. Map remote authentication errors to suitable user messages without exposing implementation details.

Retest. Check empty and malformed inputs, incorrect credentials and successful owner sign-in. Verify keyboard/focus and error announcements on the real interface. Password recovery, abuse limits and session cleanup require separate tests.

Potential issues requiring further testing

P1 Backup and device transfer may include sensitive state

No explicit `allowBackup`, `fullBackupContent` or `dataExtractionRules` setting appears in the manifest. Android generally enables eligible app-data backup by default, with behavior varying by OS, device, encryption and account settings.[2] This confirms an unspecified policy, not an actual backup leak. It also does not mean unauthenticated modern `adb backup` can extract the app.

Inspect saved files, preferences, databases and tokens; define deliberate exclusions or opt out as appropriate. Test both cloud restore and device-to-device transfer. Confirm that restored sessions and caches do not expose data before authentication or cross account boundaries.

P2 Server authorization and invitation controls are high-impact unknowns

The package represents estate IDs, owner/executor roles, six-character invitation codes and backend operations such as estate creation and account deletion. A public Supabase publishable client key is included, as expected for a client app; it is not evidence of a leaked privileged secret. Effective database/storage policies and function authorization cannot be determined from that key or the interface. Supabase documents publishable keys as suitable for shipped clients, with access controlled by user authentication and Row Level Security policies.[9][10] The successful own-membership and estate-existence reads below are positive checks only; they do not demonstrate that unauthorized requests are denied.

Use two controlled accounts and two estates to test direct database/storage requests, owner/executor CRUD, attachment URLs, guessed or altered estate IDs, membership removal, expired sessions and concurrent role changes. Verify invite randomness, expiry, single use where appropriate, revocation, throttling and account binding. Confirm all role enforcement occurs server-side. Executor simulation text expressly refers to a UI-only preview; do not mistake that simulation for backend security testing.

P3 Local sessions, biometric locking and cached attachments need lifecycle testing

Local-auth, shared-preference, SQLite and photo-cache code is included. No dedicated secure-storage plugin is registered, but that alone does not prove plaintext credentials or absence of another encryption mechanism. Limited phone checks supported the advertised background relock and cold-relaunch prompt, as detailed below. Biometric authentication results do not automatically bind document decryption to a hardware-backed key.

Cancellation remained inconclusive when the device connection was interrupted. Lockout, no enrollment, device-credential fallback, account/estate switching and deletion need separate tests. Visible sign-out protection does not prove sensitive caches or tokens are removed from storage. Inspect remaining documents, previews, tokens and signed URLs; cache-clear helpers do not prove every necessary path invokes them. Check protection in other activities/viewers and recent-app previews.

P4 Custom-scheme links and embedded WebViews need input validation checks

The exported activity accepts `com.undercroft.undercroft:` without manifest host/path restrictions. The scheme's difference from the application ID is legal and not inherently a bug. Custom schemes are not exclusive; another installed app can claim them.[4] Validate callback host/path, state or PKCE, expiry and replay protection, and behavior while logged out or biometrically locked. One bare custom-scheme Settings link sent while signed out left the app on sign-in controls. This is a positive single sample, not proof of every recovery callback, replay or lock-state guard. Prefer verified HTTPS App Links where appropriate.

WebView plugin APIs include JavaScript bridges and SSL-error handling methods because they are general-purpose infrastructure. Their inclusion does not prove that UnderCroft bypasses TLS checks or enables dangerous file access. Inspect the actual Dart configuration, navigation allowlists and bridge-message validation. The internal URL-launcher WebView is not exported and its JavaScript/DOM options default false. It does not set the main activity's screenshot flag, a conditional consistency concern if sensitive content opens there.

P5 The packaged YouTube template executes message commands without visible origin checks

The bundled YouTube player HTML, around lines 97-114, registers a message listener, parses JSON and evaluates a supplied function expression; no sender-origin/source check is visible there, and the response uses a wildcard target origin. This is a confirmed dependency pattern with unproven exploitability in this app.

Determine which frames can send messages in the deployed WebView and what bridge capabilities are reachable. Review or update the dependency and prefer narrowly defined commands with appropriate sender validation. No arbitrary native-code execution, credential theft or exploitable attack path was demonstrated.

P6 Alternate deletion wording needs branch verification; current owner copy agrees with public materials

The reached owner Settings screen describes estate-wide deletion, matching the public demo and privacy explanation. This supersedes the earlier confirmed C3 contradiction finding. The APK also contains different account-departure text at ARM64 offset `0x56381` that preserves the shared estate, alongside estate-deletion text at `0x64d93`; the preserving branch was not reached. It may belong to another role/ownership scenario, an alternate flow or obsolete code. Inclusion alone does not establish a current user-facing contradiction.[6][7]

Verify intended account departure, ownership transfer and estate erasure semantics for each role and estate situation; remove obsolete text and explain the specific consequence before confirmation. Deletion was not executed on the shared estate. Backend erasure, retention, attachments/backups and effects on other participants remain untested. No confirmation dialog or server deletion result was established by reading the Settings explanation.

Protective controls and engineering observations

The main activity applies Android `FLAG_SECURE`.[3] On the tested Samsung phone, ordinary screenshot capture returned a black app area, supporting the expected capture protection. This is a positive privacy observation, not an app rendering defect, and does not establish every recent-app preview or external-viewer path is protected. It cannot secure APK assets and limits screenshot-based visual evidence. Non-exported sharing providers use app cache paths with URI grants; printing and sharing use dedicated subdirectories. Image picker exposes the broader cache directory, which warrants scope review but is not a demonstrated disclosure.

No explicit cleartext opt-in or debuggable flag appears. That is encouraging Android configuration, but does not certify Dart socket behavior, certificate pinning or every network path. All twelve native libraries have non-executable stack flags and no writable/executable load segments. All native load alignments are 16 KB or 64 KB, and stored ZIP data offsets are multiples of 16 KB. These satisfy structural alignment prerequisites; actual operation on a 16 KB OS remains untested.[5]

The universal APK contains approximately 60.4 MB of native-library data across three architectures. App Bundle/per-architecture distribution could reduce download size. This is an optimization, not a functional defect. Both song and example-video CSV assets are present; different headers do not establish a parser bug, because the latter appears connected to an example-download feature. Remove unused release assets only after verifying their purpose.

Functionality and usability test status

Real-device environment, account and evidence limits

The same-hash APK was successfully installed and launched on Samsung SM-S938B, Android 17/API 37. The reached app Settings reports version 1.0.0(14), matching the artifact. The supplied developer demo owner credentials opened the existing shared demo estate. Tests deliberately avoided estate-record edits, new invitations/memberships and account/estate deletion. Ordinary navigation may initialize backend context; no claim is made that it caused no server activity. The OS/Bitwarden save prompt was declined. This prompt is not an UnderCroft permission request or evidence about the app's own token storage.

The app area was black in ordinary captures, consistent with the statically confirmed secure-window flag. UI hierarchy text and control names support navigation and copy findings; they do not certify font appearance, contrast, actual clipping, media audio or complete screen-reader interaction. Settings, Sign out and

password-visibility controls have semantic names in the saved hierarchy. Blank serialized input hints are insufficient evidence that the visual fields lack labels.

The initial isolated Android 14/API 34 x86_64 emulator did not finish booting: Android system-package activation and zygote failures left ADB offline, and that emulator's installation attempt returned `device offline`. The emulator and task-created connection server were stopped without changing the original AVD. The later successful real-phone run supersedes the earlier conclusion that no Android testing was possible; it does not establish a supported-device matrix or explain the emulator's root cause.

Completed phone observations and limits

All ten dashboard sections were opened and navigated: My Letter To You, What to Do First, Legal Documents, Who to Notify, Running the House, Funeral Arrangements, Cars, Probate, My Songs and Ad Hoc Data. What to Do First was scrolled through six screenfuls; Running the House, Funeral Arrangements and Cars through two each; Probate through five, including its help dialog and Close action. No app crash was observed during these tested paths. No deliberate estate records, playlist entries, invitations or memberships were created, edited or deleted.

Area	Observed result and practical limit
Installation and launch	Same APK installed and launched on one real Samsung phone; upgrade, other devices and long-run stability untested
Owner sign-in and sign-out	Demo owner signed in and dashboard opened. Sign out returned to login; Back and cold launch remained at login
Empty authentication forms	Confirmed C4: confusing implementation-level errors on empty Sign up and Sign in
Section navigation and help	All ten sections reached; Letter and Probate help opened and closed; section scrolling and Back exercised. No editable-data persistence test
Settings and deletion copy	Owner role/version and current deletion explanation reached; copy agrees with public materials. No Delete action or server erasure executed
Local executor preview	Initially off; enabled locally. Ad Hoc editable fields changed from four to zero; preview restored off. No actual executor session or backend-permission test
External resources	Privacy, Support and Demo opened expected Chrome URLs and Back returned to app; no support submission
Legal documents and viewer	PDF slots empty; existing memory image opened and viewer closed. No PDF upload/render/share/print pass
File picker	Attempted PDF-picker interaction/cancellation insufficiently verified; no successful cancellation or import conclusion
Music controls	Existing 33-track playlist selected; Play led to Now Playing and elapsed state advancing to about 48 seconds. Controls and Pause returned Play/Selected Track state around 50 seconds. Heard audio and visual quality unassessed
Biometric relock	Enablement authenticated; long-background and cold-relaunch prompts observed, with successful user authentication after the long-background test. Cancellation/lockout/fallback not established
Logged-out link sample	One bare custom-scheme Settings VIEW attempt stayed on login. Other callbacks and security edge cases untested
Device matrix and accessibility	Phone used 4,096-byte memory pages and unchanged font scale 1.0. Actual 16 KB operation, TalkBack, scaling, contrast and detailed visual geometry untested

Biometric sequence. The switch started off. Enabling it invoked Samsung authentication, after which it was checked on. A sampled Home-and-resume interval of about 0.23 seconds returned to Settings without a prompt. After about 72.7 seconds in the background, reopening displayed Samsung authentication; the user authenticated successfully and Settings returned. A force-stop/cold relaunch also displayed authentication. These observations support the stated more-than-one-minute relock policy on one device, not every lifecycle or failure state.

The cancellation attempt reached system Settings and then lost the debugging connection, leaving its security outcome inconclusive. The user reported Samsung Auto Blocker had turned back on and temporarily disabled it, restoring the connection, with their own 30-minute automatic-restoration arrangement. The reviewer did not change Auto Blocker or other global phone settings and does not attribute that interruption to an app bypass. At cleanup, UnderCroft's biometric lock and executor preview were both verified off, matching their initial values.

Cleanup and remaining boundaries. The app was left installed and signed out; cold launch and the sampled Settings link showed sign-in controls. The reviewer's temporary phone-side UI dump was removed and the task connection server stopped. UI checks did not inspect storage for token/cache erasure. Actual executor access, RLS denial/cross-estate isolation, record CRUD, uploads, deletion, invitation handling, email recovery, offline conflicts and media sound remain untested. No comprehensive usability or accessibility pass is claimed.

The accompanying matrix contains 87 cases: seven static cases, four API-only cases, 42 broad runtime acceptance cases and 34 narrowly scoped phone observations. The broad runtime cases comprise 2 Passed-phone, 30 Not run, 1 Failed-phone, 9 Partially tested-phone. The phone observations comprise 27 Passed-phone, 2 Failed-phone, 2 Inconclusive-phone, 3 Observed-phone. Broad acceptance cases overlap the narrower observations; these counts are not an independent pass rate. Two failed phone observations concern the single C4 blank-form defect. Inconclusive results remain distinct from failures.

Separate limited API-only observations

Before the phone run, ordinary HTTPS authentication using the supplied developer demo credentials succeeded. A user-filtered read returned exactly one membership with role `owner`; an identifier-only read confirmed its associated own estate existed. Local logout succeeded for that newly created API session only (`scope=local`). No estate name, document or private record contents were requested in this API-only check, and no negative authorization, cross-estate, executor, invitation, mutation or deletion test was performed. These positive API observations remain distinct from phone navigation and do not establish RLS completeness or app session cleanup.

For a sensitive, infrequently used application, remaining usability work should prioritize predictable retrieval during stress: clear section labels, save state, deletion consequences, recovery and understandable owner/executor permissions. Test long names, empty sections, large documents, denied/cancelled pickers, expired sessions, interrupted connectivity and accidental navigation with disposable records. Included platform-specific wording should be checked on an actual reached Android screen before being reported as a displayed terminology defect.

Remaining limitations and how to resolve them

These gaps are practical follow-up work, not reasons to discard the confirmed findings. Completing them requires the specific evidence or environment below.

Limitation	What would resolve it	Result that could then be assessed
Shared demo restricts mutation testing	A dedicated estate containing fictional data; owner and genuine executor accounts; spare invites; access to test registration/reset mail; explicit permission to erase that estate	Create/edit/save/reload, uploads, recovery, invitations, role changes, departure and deletion, including effects on other participants

Limitation	What would resolve it	Result that could then be assessed
Cross-estate isolation untested	A second unrelated disposable estate and account, plus an agreed bounded API test scope	Negative access checks for database rows, storage objects and server functions. A local executor preview alone cannot establish authorization
Security implementation opaque	Dart source, dependency lockfiles, backend migrations and effective database/storage policies, server functions, signing and retention design; preferably a test environment	Actual authorization rules, token/cache lifecycle, link validation, biometric enforcement, backup handling and whether packaged alternate text is reachable. Production administrator credentials are unnecessary for a source review
Packaged document authenticity unknown	Developer confirmation of whether every included document is synthetic, followed by a clean rebuilt APK and new package inventory	Whether distribution exposed confidential material and whether remediation removed it. Omission from a visible screen does not remove bundled data
Native visual and accessibility assessment limited	An observed session on a test phone, including large text and TalkBack, with a human checking the screen; a purpose-built test build may support review captures using fictional data	Readability, focus order, target sizes, clipping, error recovery, image/PDF interaction and audio quality. Secure screenshot blocking is a privacy control, not evidence of poor rendering
One device and interrupted biometric cancellation	A stable connection for cancellation/fallback tests; further supported Android devices or an emulator on a suitably configured computer, including a 16 KB environment	Lifecycle edge cases, device compatibility, upgrade/migration, offline recovery and actual 16 KB execution. Static alignment is not an execution test
Demo assistive and performance checks incomplete	Screen-reader and browser-zoom sessions, other browsers, measured network profiles and listening to narration	Assistive navigation, intelligibility, pause behavior and realistic loading performance
Legal review is a source-based content check	Review by a probate practitioner for each supported jurisdiction, using the corrected wording and complete conditional flows	Professional validation of England and Wales, Northern Ireland and Scottish guidance; exceptional estates and legal maintenance ownership

For bereaved-user suitability, recruit representative executors and observe concrete tasks: find the will's location, identify the next urgent action, recover from a mistaken step and understand what is saved or shared. Record completion, assistance needed and misunderstandings. Expert inspection cannot substitute for that evidence. Rebuild-and-retest after fixes; the present APK hash identifies the version reviewed here.

Recommended release sequence

1. **Correct the distributed artifact.** Remove personal documents and estate-specific seed content, use synthetic examples, rebuild, inventory the new package and verify that removed data is absent from assets and native strings.
2. **Establish production release identity.** Configure protected signing, verify the final certificate and plan updates from existing installs.
3. **Correct validation and verify deletion branches.** Replace the empty-form errors with field guidance. Preserve the current owner deletion-copy agreement while checking alternate-role wording, backend behavior and retention using disposable users and estates.
4. **Prove the core trust boundaries.** Test RLS/storage/function authorization, owner/executor permissions, invitations and recovery links using direct requests as well as the UI.
5. **Validate sensitive-data lifecycle.** Inspect local sessions, cache cleanup, biometric transitions, backups, restore and exported attachments.

6. **Complete functional and usability coverage.** Extend the initial real-phone observations to representative supported versions, large text, TalkBack, interrupted networking and 16 KB execution. Use disposable synthetic records for editing/deletion and record reproducible failures.

For efficient follow-up, request the Dart source, pubspec.lock, Flutter SDK revision, Gradle dependency/SBOM information, migrations and RLS/storage policies, server functions, intended deletion/retention rules and dedicated test accounts. These would turn the highest-impact unknowns into verifiable engineering findings.

References and evidence

App-specific findings are grounded in the evaluated APK. Reproduction locators include its compiled manifest; signature-verification output; `assets/flutter_assets/assets/`; ARM64 `libapp.so` offsets cited above; `MainActivity.onCreate`; `GeneratedPluginRegistrant`; provider-path XML; and the YouTube player HTML. Decompiler output is supporting evidence and may differ from original source formatting.

1. Android app signing - development and release signing behavior.
2. Android Auto Backup - default eligibility, exclusions and transfer considerations.
3. Android FLAG_SECURE - screenshot and display protection.
4. Android unsafe deep links - link validation and interception risks.
5. Android 16 KB page sizes - native and packaging checks and runtime requirements.
6. UnderCroft privacy policy - public deletion/sharing explanation checked during this review.
7. UnderCroft public demo and underlying walkthrough - public feature and Settings narration.
8. UnderCroft support - availability and form inspected; no submission made.
9. Supabase API keys - publishable client keys and their security boundaries.
10. Supabase Row Level Security - server-enforced row access and policy requirements.

UnderCroft public website demo independent evaluation

Private review | 8 November 2026 | All 27 slides examined

Executive judgment

UnderCroft has a useful information-organising concept. The public demonstration shows broad coverage, a consistent visual style and practical household/document examples.

The demo is not yet dependable training for a bereaved executor. It mainly tours an owner's editing features. It does not sufficiently teach the urgent executor journey, establish whether work has been saved or a notification completed, or separate personal instructions from maintained general guidance. Some represented-app copy needs correction, while the website player has independently identifiable accessibility and resilience defects.

The most consequential confirmed content findings concern recurring subscriptions and lost-will guidance. A smaller Apple terminology error could obstruct a real task. Current owner Settings agrees with the demo's deletion explanation; different packaged wording remains unreached and needs branch verification. Correct the confirmed errors before extending the demo's audience. Other criticisms—visual priority, emotional tone, findability and technical burden—are design concerns requiring user testing rather than demonstrated failures for every reader.

This report distinguishes the live website, its source, its narration and pictured app screens. It does not certify the Android application's runtime, legal guidance, backend security, accessibility or suitability for an individual's estate.

What was examined

The review examined the public demo page, its saved HTML/CSS/JavaScript and its linked walkthrough data. All 27 scripts were read and all 27 embedded images decoded and visually inspected. The reviewer also visited all 27 steps sequentially in a real browser. Individual navigation, playback, keyboard and layout observations are recorded below.

Observed browser results

All 27 steps were visited sequentially with Next, completing the loop, and all 27 dot selectors were clicked and matched the expected title. Previous from the first step reached step 27; Next from step 27 returned to step 1. These navigation routes worked.

Check	Observed result
Native buttons	Previous, Play/Pause and Next all activated with Enter. Next then lost keyboard focus to the page body.
Playback state	Play changed to Pause; Pause changed back to Play. Automatic progression was observed from step 11 through step 15.
Navigation while playing	Next moved from step 15 to step 16 and retained Pause state; pressing Pause then stopped progression.
Initial narration	Browser autoplay was blocked initially; the displayed prompt cleared after Play. This is expected browser policy handling.

Check	Observed result
Viewports	622 × 686, 390 × 844, 1280 × 800 and 320 × 568 checked. No horizontal overflow; narrow layouts needed vertical scrolling.
Image enlargement	Clicking the first probate picture did not open an enlarged/new view. No explicit zoom control was present.
Orientation and persistence	No numerical position, topic menu or slide-specific URL. Reload from step 16 returned to step 1.

Audible quality, pronunciation and true pause/resume were not verified by listening. Actual screen-reader use, browser zoom, other browsers and representative network performance were not tested. The page contained no hyperlinks; pictured app links and controls were static screenshot content. The transcript was visible, while image alternative text consisted only of slide titles.

All records have a nonempty script and valid image. Twenty-five are 1206 × 2622 screenshots; the cover and collage have different dimensions. Many screenshots have an iOS-style status bar. A version label matching an APK does not establish that the pictures show its current Android behavior. Pictures of Save, Delete, invitations and other app controls are illustrations within the demo, not proof those underlying operations were executed.

A later limited phone follow-up installed the same APK on a Samsung SM-S938B running Android 17 / API 37, reached the demo-owner estate and inspected selected sections. This included authentication and biometric checks, with the biometric setting restored off. No deliberate estate-content edits or deletion were performed. These native observations qualify specific statements below; they do not turn the website's screenshots into proof of all represented app workflows. The separate phone follow-up records the detailed results and limits.

“Confirmed” below means directly established source behavior, visible copy or an observed interaction. A conditional code defect is labeled with its triggering condition. “Concern” means a plausible difficulty or incomplete explanation. “Untested” means no outcome can be inferred. This is a detailed review of the public demonstration, not a comprehensive legal or WCAG conformance audit. Private-looking example contents and invitation codes are omitted.

Confirmed website findings

W1 Medium priority — Direct step selectors lack keyboard and accessible-control semantics

Evidence. The player creates its navigation dots as clickable spans without button roles, keyboard focusability, accessible names or semantic current-step state. Inactive indicators are only 8 × 8 CSS pixels. Source calculations give inactive dots approximately 1.72:1 contrast against the page, although the main text and button text have strong contrast.

Consequence. A keyboard or assistive-technology user cannot use the direct selectors as ordinary named controls. This does not mean the whole tour is inaccessible: the native Previous/Play/Next buttons provide sequential navigation. Tiny direct targets also make selecting a particular point unnecessarily difficult.

Fix and retest. Use real buttons with step number/title names, larger hit areas and an exposed current state. Add visible position and an unobtrusive slide-change announcement. Test keyboard and screen-reader selection. These recommendations follow WCAG's keyboard, naming and control principles; no blanket conformance result is asserted.[7]

W2 Medium priority — Speech-unavailable fallback can fail before its check

Evidence. The narration routine calls `speechSynthesis.cancel()` before checking whether the speech API exists. Navigation and Pause also call it unguarded. A browser without that API will throw before the intended timed fallback. This is a confirmed conditional source defect; it is not proof that the browser used in this review lacks speech support.

Fix and retest. Guard every speech operation, preserve manual navigation without audio and show a useful status when speech is unavailable. Test with support absent, speech denied and speech errors. Existing handling of a browser's initial autoplay refusal is intentional and should not be mislabeled as a product failure.

W3 Low priority — Play restarts narration after Pause

Evidence. The implementation cancels the utterance on Pause and starts a new utterance containing the complete script when Play is pressed. It does not implement speech pause/resume or retain position. This is source-confirmed behavior. The live test confirmed state changes and stopping progression, but did not verify the audible restart by listening.

Consequence and fix. A reader who pauses to process unfamiliar information must hear that slide again. Either provide a true resume mechanism or label the behavior clearly as restarting the slide. Keep the transcript available and test repeated pause, navigation and replay without unintended advancement.

W4 Medium priority — Keyboard navigation loses the focused control

Observed. Next was focused and activated with Enter. The slide changed, but the document's active element became the page body. The source moves the controls into the new slide header, consistent with the observed loss.

Consequence. A keyboard user loses their place after a successful navigation action and must recover focus to continue. This is a reproduced interaction defect, separate from the unnamed dot selectors. It does not establish a screen-reader failure in every browser.

Fix and retest. Keep controls in a stable location or deliberately preserve the triggering control's focus. Repeat Next/Previous by keyboard across several slides, including wraparound, and verify the next focus target and announced title. Do not move focus during automatic playback unnecessarily.

Confirmed content defects in the represented app or narration

D2 Subscription guidance confuses stopping payment with closing the service

The digital-affairs picture broadly reassures readers that a bank freeze will handle recurring subscriptions and implies provider contact should not be needed. This is an unsafe generalization for a reusable guide. The FCA explicitly distinguishes stopping a recurring card payment from ending the underlying contract.[3]

Explain that payment arrangements, subscriptions and account closure are separate matters and that the relevant provider's process must be checked. Show how to record a provider notification and its result. This finding evaluates generic instructional copy; it does not determine contractual obligations for a particular deceased person.

D3 Lost-will wording and original-location instructions need correction

The second probate picture dismisses a photocopy as having no use in court. That absolute wording conflicts with HMCTS's lost-will procedure, which can consider a copy with supporting evidence. Preserving the original remains important, but the demonstration should provide a qualified missing-original route.[4]

The same pictured card also presents two different original-will storage instructions together. Their truth is unknown; the contradiction in what a reader is told is visible. Use one authoritative owner-maintained location

with a review date, and replace alarming absolutes with an appropriate help route. No personal locations are reproduced here.

D4 Apple instructions use the wrong key term

The digital-affairs image uses `Asset Key` in an Apple settings path. Apple's current guidance uses `Access Key` and `View Access Key`.[5] Correct the term and verify the full route for supported versions. Distinguish legacy account access from unlocking a device and accessing purchased content. A small navigation-copy error can block a difficult task even when the overall intent is sound.

Runtime clarification of the earlier deletion finding

D1 Packaged alternate deletion wording remains unreached

The demo and public policy describe estate-wide deletion. The subsequently reached Android owner Settings screen uses matching wording about deleting the estate and ending granted access. This supersedes any suggestion that the reached current UI contradicts the demo. Different text preserving a shared estate exists in the APK but its display path was not reached; it may be conditional or obsolete. Treat it as static copy ambiguity requiring branch verification, not a confirmed active documentation failure.[1][2]

Deletion was not pressed on the shared estate. No confirmation dialog, backend erasure, retention outcome or effect on other participants was tested. Verify role-specific departure, ownership-transfer, account and estate-erasure behavior before revising the explanation. Preserve useful distinctions without claiming that the displayed promise has been proved true or false.

Design concerns and unresolved risks

Cancellation errors from an old utterance can schedule fallback timing without identifying the current playback generation. Unexpected advancement is a plausible race, not a reproduced failure: the tested navigation retained playing state and Pause stopped progression. Invalidate stale callbacks and test rapid navigation, without assuming this race occurred.

The tour loops rather than providing a completion state and does not display a numerical step count, topic menu or slide-specific link. Reloading reset progress to the first step. These observed choices weaken orientation in a 27-step learning resource; they are design limitations rather than navigation failures. Offer topic access, progress, replay and a clear finish. The visible transcript and strong page/button text contrast are positive.

Tall screenshots are capped at 55% of viewport height. In the tested phone view their content was approximately 214 CSS pixels wide; at 1280 × 800 it was approximately 202 pixels wide. Their embedded text was tiny, especially in the four-panel collage. Clicking the probate picture did not enlarge it. Provide close-ups/full-size access and explanatory text. No horizontal overflow appeared at the tested widths, which is positive; actual browser zoom remains untested.

The complete walkthrough JSON is 19,732,097 response bytes, approximately 18.8 MiB, including roughly 14.8 MB of decoded images. The player fetches/parses it all and creates every slide image without per-slide lazy loading. This is measured asset inefficiency, not a reproduced loading failure or speed benchmark. Use right-sized separate compressed images, load current/nearby content and provide retry for poor connections.

Regional and legal-process copy needs scoped review. One view groups England, Wales and Northern Ireland; others show Scottish/local procedures. This does not prove that every screen is served to every region, but the tour does not establish correct coverage. GOV.UK states that Tell Us Once is unavailable for people living in Northern Ireland.[8] Use distinct relevant routes and maintain sources/review dates.

The phone follow-up also reached a probate header showing the combined England/Wales/NI selection, and Cars text still referred to Scottish Confirmation. These are confirmed reachable wording observations, not a

failed grant application or proof of every region's routing. The probate example concerns an existing will, so explaining named executors is reasonable. The categorical wording still needs a scope statement and separate help routes for no will, missing originals or unavailable representatives.[6] A separate legal-content fact-check provides detailed jurisdiction and tax-signatory corrections. This report does not declare the entire pictured process legally wrong or determine an individual estate.

External notifications require equally clear boundaries. Recording a company in UnderCroft, opening an external service, sending a notification and receiving acknowledgement are different states. The demo has not established a working integration or universal provider coverage. Explain the user's responsibility and show status rather than implying automation from a stored list.

Realistic personal records and a visible invitation code appear in the public examples. Authenticity and live validity were not established. Use clearly fictional, nonfunctional data; do not test privacy by redeeming public codes. Demonstrate field-level sharing decisions for sensitive identifiers, device credentials and documents, including what access removal can and cannot retract after export.

Source cleanup without an observed user-visible failure

One organization-detail slide retains an unfinished description in the data; other descriptions/scripts have minor spelling or spacing errors. The description metadata was not exposed in the tested player interface. Treat that placeholder as maintenance cleanup, not a reproduced visible defect. Correct narration spelling and consistency in the source before further publication.

Complete slide register

All 27 scripts and images were reviewed. The assessments below concern the demonstration's clarity and coverage; they do not certify the operations pictured.

Slide	Topic	Assessment
1	Welcome	Personal identity gives warmth, but the introduction assumes an owner preparing for death. State who the tour helps, its outcome and length, and distinguish preparation from urgent executor use.
2	Sign up	Entry choices are clearly separated. The title describes registration while the picture is an entry menu. Explain the roles and invite route before progressing; keep step wording consistent with its purpose.
3	Email and password	The form looks simple, with a visibility toggle and returning-user path. Show required rules, verification and success/error outcomes. The still and short narration do not establish authentication usability.
4	Joining	Creating versus joining is understandable. Narration implies invite holders are executors although later invitations also cover co-owners. Explain that the invitation determines the role, then show the executor route.
5	Estate name	One obvious task and reassurance about renaming reduce hesitation. Define what estate means in this shared-data product and show the created result so users do not confuse it with a legal-status declaration.
6	Main screen	Labeled icons and consistent large cards support scanning. Equally prominent sections do not prioritize urgent work. Add task-oriented access and demonstrate how an executor finds the essential record quickly.
7	Personal letter	Emotionally clear and spacious. A handwriting face may be harder over long text. Explain readers, visibility and save feedback; offer a plain-font option. Absence of pictured save feedback is a test question.

Slide	Topic	Assessment
8	First tasks 1	Personal memories may comfort some families, but photo customization precedes immediate actions and dominates the viewport. Make urgent work primary; allow optional memories and personal humor without assuming a universal bereavement tone.
9	First tasks 2	Photo/notes help practical pet handover. Distinguish immediate care and responsible contacts from insurance or identifier administration. Demonstrate retrieval and completion rather than only the record's fields.
10	First tasks overview	The collage shows breadth but compresses several processes into miniature images. Use separate close-ups and short tasks. Explain local/jurisdiction boundaries, document states and optional music instead of treating the collage as training.
11	Wills	Keeping a copy while identifying the original's custodian is useful. Large illustration delays the records. Show synthetic upload/open/retrieval steps and what to do when the original cannot be found.
12	Property documents	Upload limits and an add action are visible. The empty list should not imply verified official records exist. Clarify registry and document provenance; put the practical checklist before optional media.
13	Notification contacts	Personal contacts and organizations are sensibly separated. Explain that visiting another service and actually notifying it are separate actions. Do not let a broad automation claim substitute for an acknowledged completion state.
14	Add organization	A concise dialog has clear confirmation/cancellation. Show the resulting saved record and distinguish creation from sending anything. Test keyboard/focus live rather than inferring dialog behavior from a picture.
15	Digital affairs	Numbered instructions help, but subscription generalizations and Apple key terminology need correction. Separate payments, account closure, legacy access and device unlock; point to maintained provider guidance rather than categorical promises.
16	Organization details	Separate organization/account records have explicit saves. Multiple save/delete pairs need clear scope and dirty-state feedback. Clean unused description metadata and use unambiguously fictional financial examples.
17	Household operation	Photos with practical notes are especially valuable. Paired columns narrow the text. Show executor retrieval, enlargement and incomplete-data handling; separate ordinary instructions from safety guidance requiring appropriate professional help.
18	Add funeral wishes	A short person-based entry supports multiple records. Explain whether it represents preferences, a booking or a checklist. Demonstrate creation and cancellation with synthetic names and preserve existing work.
19	Funeral plan	Wishes, payment details and provider link are grouped usefully. Clarify their status and authority, provide a clear contact action, and demonstrate save/delete safeguards. Optional music should not displace urgent contact information.
20	Vehicles	Combining documents, insurance and tasks is useful. Categorical rules need current policy/jurisdiction scope. Distinguish generic guidance from personal location notes; the narration barely explains the insurance content visible on screen.
21	Probate introduction	Showing the selected process region helps. Grouping regions requires exceptions. Personal imagery and profit-related humor may distract or upset some readers; keep it attributable/optional and lead with calm practical next steps.
22	Probate steps	A stepwise structure is suitable. Correct lost-will absolutes and contradictory location instructions. Scope executor-only statements to the example and provide a no-will/missing-original help route with maintained official references.

Slide	Topic	Assessment
23	Songs	Playback status, an example file and replacement warning are helpful. CSV preparation imposes a technical burden. Demonstrate an import result and recovery, offer simpler entry, and explain unavailable media without requiring music use.
24	Additional records	Flexible notes cover unusual knowledge. The ad hoc label is jargon; use plain task-based naming. Long instructions need findability, audience and save clarity. Use synthetic examples without personal access instructions.
25	Settings 1	Labeled identity and regional groups aid orientation. Narration mentions biometric/preview features not visible in this still. Demonstrate them separately and clarify the difference between person records, account membership and removal of access.
26	Sharing	The sole-access warning addresses a real continuity risk. Bring it earlier; explain invitation acceptance, recipient identity, revocation and privilege differences. Public examples should never contain a potentially usable access code.
27	Help and deletion	Help is visibly separate from the destructive action. Current owner Settings agrees with the demo; alternate packaged wording remains unreached. Verify departure/erasure branches, retention and others' access with safe fictional tests.

Suitability for bereaved executors

Teach an urgent task before a full feature catalogue

An owner may enjoy customization. An executor may need a contact or document within minutes. Offer a short executor-first route: accept access, confirm the estate/person, understand permissions, find the immediate list, open one record and mark a task complete. Keep the wider owner tour available without making it a prerequisite.

Prioritize who acts, what is needed, whether information is available and what can wait. Show safe recovery from missing information. Evaluate findability with representative users rather than assuming spacious cards mean fast retrieval.

Make progress and saved work trustworthy

Several scripts point at features without showing outcomes. Demonstrate the difference between unsaved, saved, sent, acknowledged and complete. Where multiple Save/Delete controls appear, make their scope obvious. Show cancellation and return navigation without losing work. Test this in the actual product; screenshots cannot prove persistence.

Preparation completeness must not imply legal readiness or completion of an estate. A reassuring status should explain what it measures, identify gaps and avoid making an overwhelmed person feel they have failed.

Separate personal warmth from product authority

Family memories and humor may be meaningful. They should be clearly owner-authored, optional and collapsible when someone needs practical help. Generic instructions should use a calm tone, plain language and maintained sources. This respects different relationships, family structures and emotional reactions without removing the application's personal character.

Explain owner/executor permissions early and in practical terms. Sensitive data should have an intentional audience; printing, sharing and previously downloaded copies need an honest explanation. Do not imply that a role label itself guarantees all relevant security behavior.

Plan for poor circumstances

The tour assumes a connected user with an account, invitation and prepared records. Demonstrate expired access, missing invitations, an unavailable document, poor signal and a route to assistance. Consider a suitably protected offline/printable essential-information summary; this review has not established whether the app already provides one.

Use plain fonts, concise headings and restrained optional media. Test larger text, screen readers, low vision, older devices and users unfamiliar with files/CSV. The website's visible transcript is useful; screenshot text still needs explanatory alternatives and enlargement. Assess actual browser focus, announcements and controls before calling the experience accessible.

Recommended priorities and limits

First correct the consequential copy and replace realistic examples. Next fix direct-selector accessibility and speech fallback; verify playback/navigation without regressions. Then add executor-first training, clear source/status boundaries and improved image loading/enlargement. Finally test the revised journey with representative executors using fictional estates: measure time to information, mistaken assumptions, confidence in saved/completed work and recovery from uncertainty.

Android coverage remains limited to the separately recorded phone follow-up. Destructive deletion, comprehensive backend/data behavior, notification delivery, invitation validity and legal completeness remain unverified. Audio quality, actual screen-reader operation, browser zoom, other browsers and representative network performance were not tested for this website review.

Primary references

1. UnderCroft demo and walkthrough data.
2. UnderCroft privacy policy.
3. FCA recurring card payments.
4. HMCTS lost-will procedure.
5. Apple Legacy Contact and access-key guidance.
6. GOV.UK applying without a will.
7. W3C Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.2.
8. GOV.UK Tell Us Once eligibility.

UnderCroft legal and factual content review

Probate, confirmation and practical after-death guidance | 8 November 2026 | Private review

Overall finding and scope

The reviewed guidance contains useful preparation advice alongside several statements that should be corrected before being relied on by an executor. The strongest errors concern lost wills, who may sign tax returns, the Scottish HMRC-to-court procedure, subscription cancellation and Apple Legacy access. Other passages turn sensible recommendations into universal legal requirements or promise outcomes that depend on the estate, provider or court.

This is a source-based content fact check, not a solicitor's opinion on a particular estate. It does not assess the validity of the family's wills, ownership of their property, their tax position or any individual insurance policy. Current primary sources were checked on 8 November 2026. Findings distinguish incorrect copy, advice requiring qualification, topics not demonstrated and supported points. The guidance is not uniformly wrong; preserving its useful parts while correcting the absolutes is the appropriate response.

The evidence comprises the public demo's screenshots/narration, selected text compiled into the APK, and a later limited real-phone follow-up. Reader slide numbers are one-based: slide 22 is source index 21. After the emulator failed to boot, the same APK was installed on a Samsung SM-S938B running Android 17 / API 37. Owner sign-in and selected section navigation succeeded. The selected estate process remained England/Wales/NI; neither the Scottish process nor a separate NI-only route was exercised. No deliberate estate-content edits or deletion were performed. Biometric checks were conducted with user authentication and the setting was restored off.

Phone UI-hierarchy snapshots support particular reached wording, including the combined region label and Cars' Confirmation reference. The public pictures remain illustrations, not proof of their full workflows. An unreached APK string establishes inclusion, not current display or control flow. Scottish-only text findings below retain that limitation. Screenshot capture was blocked consistently with the app's screenshot-protection flag; no visual layout or full accessibility conclusion is inferred from serialized text.

Locations deliberately identify sections rather than reproduce personal names, document locations, account details or access information. When an issue is not shown in the sampled material, this report says so; it does not infer that the whole application omits it. The most urgent changes are findings 1-4 and 7-8, followed by the conditional tax, authority and insurance guidance.

Confirmed incorrect or misleading copy

1. A will copy is not universally useless to a court

Location: visible demo slide 22, original-document card. Priority: high. The card dismisses a photocopy categorically. Preserving the latest original will and codicils is sound advice, and an ordinary grant application normally requires the original. The error is removing all exceptional routes. England and Wales has an HMCTS lost-will evidence procedure; Northern Ireland's current application guidance recognizes a court order treating a copy as an original. A copy alone is not automatically accepted, but retaining it can be important. HMCTS lost-will guidance, NI application requirements.

The same card gives conflicting instructions about the original's location. Their actual truth was not investigated, but presenting both is a confirmed retrieval defect. Use one verified custodian/contact with a review date and distinguish originals from copies. If an original cannot be found, tell the reader to preserve copies and seek the

relevant court's or a solicitor's guidance. Do not send Scottish or NI users to an England/Wales form as though it were a UK-wide route.

2. Tax-signatory and application eligibility are stated too exclusively

Location: visible demo slide 22, paragraph beneath locating the will. Priority: high. The paragraph says the people named as executors are the only people legally allowed to sign upcoming HMRC returns and the probate application. In its ordinary valid-will context, identifying the named executors is useful. As a general statement about tax authority and estate administration, the exclusivity is wrong.

The current IHT400 declaration accommodates different capacities, including an intending administrator or other appropriate declarant. Official grant guidance separately addresses administrators, unavailable executors and other routes. It does not follow that any relative or invited app user may act: entitlement and the particular form must be checked. HMRC IHT400, England/Wales valid-will applications, no-will applications, NI probate guidance.

Replace the absolute with an ordinary route and an exception route. Also distinguish signing forms from obtaining a grant: in Scotland one representative signs C1, while HMRC expects all representatives applying for confirmation to sign IHT400. An UnderCroft role called executor is an information-access role, not legal appointment. HMRC Scottish signing guidance.

3. The packaged Scottish tax hand-off uses the wrong document

Location: APK-only Scottish confirmation text and headings; current screen display unverified. Priority: high. Included wording describes HMRC creating a digital IHT421 or online clearance code and sending it directly to the Scottish court. Related headings tell the user to obtain IHT421 before submitting to the Sheriff Court.

Current HMRC instructions explicitly distinguish the jurisdictions. For Scotland, HMRC returns a stamped C1 inventory to the representative or agent, who supplies it with the other required documents to the clerk. Northern Ireland uses stamped IHT421 returned to the representative. England and Wales uses a letter containing a unique code. Calling these interchangeable can leave a Scottish applicant waiting for the wrong document or sending an incomplete package. HMRC IHTM05053.

Correct the Scottish hand-off, including who receives and lodges the document. Apply this only where the full-IHT reporting route is required; excepted estates follow a different route. This is a confirmed contradiction in included text, not proof that an observed Scottish screen or actual court application failed.

4. A bank freeze does not automatically cancel subscription contracts

Location: visible demo slide 15, Digital Subscriptions; matching APK copy. Priority: high. The guidance suggests recurring services should cancel automatically when accounts are frozen and that providers should not need contacting. This conflates stopping payment, notifying a death, closing an account and terminating a contract.

The FCA explains that cancellation of a recurring payment does not necessarily end the underlying contract. Joint-account payments may also continue, while a sole-account freeze can interrupt essential bills. This review does not determine any particular provider's terms or debt. FCA recurring card payments, MoneyHelper after-partner-death finances.

Tell the user to contact providers through their bereavement or closure process, confirm cancellation/transfer/refund, check essential ongoing payments and retain acknowledgements. Distinguish recurring card authorities from direct debits. A checklist should record an unresolved notification separately from a completed closure; a stopped payment should never be displayed as proof that all contractual administration is finished.

5. Apple's access-key terminology and navigation need correction

Location: visible demo slide 15; related APK key-delivery wording. Priority: medium. The screenshot uses Asset Key and an incorrect navigation sequence. Apple's term is access key. Its current iPhone route goes through Settings, the user's name, Sign-In & Security, Legacy Contact and the relevant person's name. A reader trying to match an unfamiliar screen needs accurate labels. Apple Legacy Contact instructions.

The included assumption that the key arrived by iMessage or email is also too narrow unless labelled as a particular family's note. The account holder may have shared or printed it; a paper/PDF copy may be stored with estate documents. Direct users to the current Apple instructions and allow a securely maintained note about where the authorized key is held. Apple sharing or printing an access key. Do not publish working keys in examples.

6. Apple Legacy does not provide every item of account or device data

Location: APK-only continuation of the Apple guidance; the full paragraph was not visible in slide 15. Priority: medium. The included all-data download promise exceeds Apple's service. Eligible iCloud/backed-up content can be available, but purchased media, subscriptions, payment information and iCloud Keychain are excluded. Data stored only locally is not made recoverable merely because Legacy access is approved. Apple data-access scope.

Explain what Legacy can and cannot provide, including its current three-year access period from first approval. Approval does remove Activation Lock for relevant devices; that part should not be called false. Reusing a locked device still requires erasure/restoration, and Legacy approval does not reveal its passcode. Warn about preserving available data before erasure. Apple request and device-reuse guidance. These distinctions matter for a product also recording passwords and planning music or memories: an expectation of universal recovery could otherwise be misleading.

7. Scottish Form 14 is conflated with full death certificates

Location: visible demo slide 10 collage, upper-right card; matching APK text. Priority: medium. The card calls Form 14 the formal Death Certificate, then instructs the reader to obtain five full certified copies. National Records of Scotland distinguishes the Certificate of Registration of Death (Form 14), supporting funeral arrangements, from the free abbreviated death certificate and purchasable full death certificates needed for some business purposes. NRS after-registration documents.

Use the precise document name and purpose for each. The association of Form 14 with the funeral director is sound. Five full copies may be a household preference, but it is not a universal legal requirement established by the source. Explain that the number needed depends on the institutions involved and their requirements. This avoids unnecessary cost and confusion about which document a bank, insurer or funeral director wants.

8. The combined regional label obscures distinct processes

Location: visible demo slide 21 banner, reached phone Settings and Probate header, and related APK setting. Priority: high. The confirmed copy issue is the combined England/Wales/NI label in the estate setting and reached Probate header. This review did not establish missing or incorrect Northern Ireland routing. England and Wales shares a probate system; Northern Ireland has a separate Probate Office, application guidance and forms. Presenting England, Wales & NI as one jurisdiction obscures differences that matter to the later instructions, including HMRC clearance documents. GOV.UK probate overview, NI forms and guidance, HMRC hand-off distinctions.

Offer three process choices: England and Wales, Northern Ireland, and Scotland, with appropriate exceptions where assets or circumstances cross borders. The combined label and reached wording do not prove that every line of code serves identical instructions to all three countries. The selector was not changed and separate country routing remains untested. Nevertheless, a reader should not have to infer which parts of a combined branch apply or discover the distinction only when an application is rejected.

Advice that needs qualification or conditional branching

9. Date-of-death valuation is sound; exactness and professional valuation are overstated

Location: visible demo slide 22, valuation and houses subsections. Priority: medium. Obtaining date-of-death balances and appropriate property values is sensible. Demanding the exact value of everything sets an unrealistic standard for assets requiring estimates. Requiring a formal written professional valuation for every property also turns prudent advice into an unconditional legal duty. HMRC expects realistic values and does not universally require professional valuations. HMRC estimating estate value, HMRC IHTM06033.

Recommend a documented professional valuation where appropriate, especially for potentially taxable, complex or uncertain property, and explain the open-market/date-of-death basis. The information-gathering step should address ownership shares, debts, relevant gifts and other interests as well as bank balances. Do not prescribe a valuation method for the family's actual properties from a screenshot. HMRC identifying assets and debts.

10. Distinguish safeguarding and notification from transacting without authority

Location: slide 22 instruction to find the original before touching any accounts; slide 10 password/PIN fields. Priority: high. Avoiding unauthorized withdrawals or distributions is a sound safeguard. Taken literally, the wording could also discourage prompt notifications, information requests or approved funeral/tax-payment arrangements. Those activities are different from signing into the deceased's accounts and moving money. GOV.UK estate administration, HMRC payment options.

Explain that sharing app information, knowing a PIN, or holding an app owner/executor role does not confer authority over another service. Use provider bereavement procedures, not the deceased's banking login. No explicit instruction to impersonate the deceased was established, so this is a safeguard to add rather than an allegation of unlawful operation. Powers of attorney also need a clear boundary: in Scotland they end when the granter dies. MoneyHelper funeral-payment guidance, Public Guardian Scotland.

11. Tax forms depend on estate status and date of death

Location: APK Scottish C1 description; general probate sequence. Priority: high. The Scottish text tells the user to complete C1 alongside the tax return. It needs a decision point, not an assumption that every estate completes IHT400. For qualifying excepted estates with deaths on or after 1 January 2022, C1 contains the necessary excepted-estate declarations without IHT400; earlier deaths can additionally require C5 or C5(SE). No tax payable is not by itself the entire test for excepted status. HMRC IHTM05027.

The description of duplicating the same assets line by line also needs correction: HMRC explains how C1 detail can avoid duplicating certain lists on IHT400 schedules. Keep current form links and ask the relevant qualifying questions before giving the user a fixed checklist. The visible England/Wales/NI screenshots do not themselves establish a universal full-return instruction. HMRC C1/IHT400 relationship.

12. Scottish small-estate and no-will procedures need an explicit alternative

Location: alternatives not demonstrated in the sampled Scottish text. Priority: medium. SCTS defines a small estate as gross money/property of £36,000 or less, before deducting debts. A clerk can assist with the inventory. No-will cases may require court appointment and a bond of caution, with conditional exemptions; it would be wrong to describe either a bond or solicitor-led preparation as mandatory in every small estate. SCTS Small Estates.

Scottish executors can be nominate or dative. Large intestate estates involve a dative-petition step; a simple valid-will checklist does not teach that route. Add date-of-death, small/large and will/no-will decisions and a clerk/legal-help referral. Do not confuse this procedural £36,000 threshold with an IHT threshold or promise that

every low-value estate has no further obligations. These are coverage requirements until the complete branch is inspected. SCTS estate guide, HMRC executor types.

13. Registration deadlines need their trigger and investigation exceptions

Location: visible slide 10 checklist and local-registration cards. Priority: high. The eight-day Scottish headline is broadly correct where possible, but investigation can affect registration. Current England/Wales guidance sets five days from receipt of the MCCD by the registrar, unless there is a coroner investigation; it should not be simplified to five days from death. Northern Ireland has its own registration route and coroner exception. Scottish registration, England/Wales medical-certification guidance, NI registration.

The phone-appointment instructions are expressly labelled Local Process. They were not independently verified against that council and should not be called universally false. Show applicability, a review date and the current council link. Scottish official guidance recognizes local arrangements and remote/in-office document delivery. Keep registration, medical certification and funeral documentation distinct rather than collapsing them into one UK-wide procedure.

14. Tell Us Once is useful but has eligibility, expiry and follow-up limits

Location: visible slide 10 notification card; broader regional settings. Priority: medium. Its listed government notifications are broadly supported. The important qualifications are that the service covers residents of England, Scotland and Wales, not Northern Ireland, and its reference expires after 28 days. Users select organizations; this is not proof that an UnderCroft checklist has submitted or completed a notification. GOV.UK Tell Us Once.

Private providers still need contact, and separate matters can remain for HMRC business affairs, property and later vehicle keeping/selling. NI needs its own bereavement route. State the deadline and remaining tasks at the point of use. Mixed screenshots and a combined region selector do not prove that NI users receive the Scottish card unconditionally; that must be checked in the actual branch. NI Bereavement Service.

15. Motor-insurance cover cannot be determined from a universal slogan

Location: visible slide 20 heading and APK continuation asserting immediate invalidity. Priority: high. Contacting the insurer before driving is appropriate. Saying cover instantly becomes invalid and all named drivers are necessarily uncovered treats a policy-dependent outcome as a universal legal rule. No actual policy was examined, so this report neither confirms continued cover nor certifies invalidation. Insurers' own bereavement instructions direct customers to discuss their cover and circumstances. LV bereavement guidance, Saga inheriting a car.

The safe instruction is to notify the insurer promptly and not drive until it confirms cover for that vehicle and driver. Cover may need continuation, amendment or replacement; tax and MOT requirements remain relevant. A commercial temporary-cover example should not imply that a particular executor, vehicle or estate will be eligible. GOV.UK vehicle-insurance requirements.

16. Vehicle keeper administration is separate from ownership and estate authority

Location: slide 20, reached phone Cars text, and APK instructions for sales, transfers and private parking. Priority: high. While the estate process remained England/Wales/NI, the phone Cars section still referred to not waiting for Scottish Confirmation before selling or transferring cars. This confirms current terminology mixing, not merely an unused native string. The claim that personal-possession status always removes the need to wait for confirmation is overbroad. Who can dispose of a vehicle depends on authority, ownership, finance and estate circumstances. This review does not establish the opposite absolute that every Scottish car sale must await confirmation. V5C is a keeper record, not proof of ownership. DVLA V5C explanation, SCTS confirmation guide.

Separate keeping, private sale, trader sale, no-logbook and off-road routes. The APK's green-slip section number is misleading; name the new-keeper slip and link to the applicable V5C instructions. Private parking alone does not complete every off-road insurance/tax requirement; SORN may be relevant. Tax does not transfer to a new keeper. DVLA keeping, DVLA selling, SORN.

17. Scottish property transfers do not all follow the same sequence

Location: APK-only Scottish property instructions; display unverified. Priority: medium. Included wording prescribes obtaining confirmation, handing it to a solicitor and using a Disposition for the properties. Professional conveyancing advice is sensible, but the sequence needs an ownership check. Registers of Scotland explains that a survivorship destination can transfer a deceased co-owner's share automatically; further executor conveyancing is needed when that wording is absent. RoS co-owned property after death.

Distinguish survivorship, register rectification, executor transfer and sale. Tell readers to check the title and get advice appropriate to their circumstances. Do not infer ownership or the correct route for the family's actual properties from the example. The correction is to avoid prescribing one deed and milestone for every case, not to encourage unassisted conveyancing.

18. Provider notifications and estimated waiting times are not guaranteed outcomes

Location: slide 13/Life Ledger copy; APK Apple and Scottish court timing text. Priority: medium. Life Ledger's notification function is supported, but its terms allow further provider steps and recommend follow-up when an account is unresolved. No UnderCroft integration was established. Present notifications as tracked requests, not automatic closure of all participating accounts. Life Ledger terms, FAQ.

The APK's Apple two-to-five-business-day and Scottish confirmation two-to-four-week statements were not supported as universal commitments by the current primary instructions reviewed. They are unsupported estimates, not proven impossible times. Remove the guarantees or attribute and date a defensible estimate, explain delays and show how to follow up. Do not replace them with another invented service promise. Apple request-status guidance, SCTS estate guidance.

Important coverage not demonstrated

Debts, claims and distribution. A grant enables further administration; it is not assurance that all liabilities are settled or the estate can immediately be distributed. Scottish Government guidance addresses paying debts first, the usual six-month period from death and potential personal liability from premature distribution. Family legal rights can matter despite a will. Do not rewrite this as every debt becoming the executor's personal debt or every possible claim expiring at six months. A clear specialist-help route is needed for insolvency, disputed claims and missing beneficiaries. These safeguards were not demonstrated in the sampled sequence. Scottish debts guidance, distribution guidance.

Tax milestones and funding. Check tax early rather than treating it as an almost-finished task. Where IHT is due, the ordinary payment deadline is the end of the sixth month after death. Public IHT400 instructions ask for submission within twelve months of death; HMRC's technical account-delivery rule is twelve months from the end of that month or, if later, three months from when the representatives first acted in that capacity. Keep form instructions and legal deadlines distinct, and obtain help where timing is uncertain. IHT400, HMRC IHTM10811. Qualifying instalments, approved direct payments and conditional grants-on-credit can affect the payment-before-grant sequence. Do not create a universal instruction to pay every penny upfront or file a full return for every estate. Coverage of these alternatives was not demonstrated. HMRC payment overview, instalments, grants on credit.

Difficult cases and provenance. The tour does not establish comprehensive handling of cross-border assets, uncertain domicile, competing wills, absent executors, business interests or incomplete records. It should identify when the simple route stops being suitable. Clearly distinguish maintained product guidance from owner-authored family notes and qualified professional advice. An uploaded will copy is a reference record, not

automatically the legally required original; app readiness is preparation coverage, not certification that estate administration is complete.

Records, evidence and changing information. The demonstrated instruction cards do not establish how readers recognize an outdated note, preserve evidence of a provider response or distinguish an unresolved action from a completed one. A practical executor view should show the person and estate concerned, the source of each instruction, the action taken, any remaining dependency and a review or completion date. A second executor should be able to understand what happened without repeating an irreversible action. Conflicting information should lead to verification, not an automatic choice between two equally confident statements. These are proposed workflow safeguards, not findings that a particular record was lost or that an existing confirmation failed. Test with a fictional missing original, a provider asking for further documents and a bank payment stopping while an essential service must continue.

Supported points worth retaining

The normal importance of the latest original will and codicils, identifying executors and requesting date-of-death information is well founded. Scottish confirmation is correctly distinguished in name from probate, and C1 is an appropriate Scottish inventory form. Eight-day Scottish registration guidance is a sound starting point with exceptions. Tell Us Once can notify the listed government bodies where eligible. Apple Legacy appropriately uses an access key and death-certificate verification, and approved access removes Activation Lock. Asking insurers before driving and recognizing that vehicle tax does not transfer are useful safeguards. Preserve these points while adding the boundaries above; a blanket warning that everything is wrong would be inaccurate and unhelpful.

Proposed replacement copy for review

The following short passages are candidate product text. Check them within the final jurisdiction-specific flow and maintain their linked sources.

Choose the correct process. Select England and Wales, Northern Ireland or Scotland. Check whether a grant is needed for the assets involved. If residence, wills or assets cross borders, seek appropriate advice.

Find the latest will and confirm who can act. Keep the original will and codicils safe. If the original is missing, preserve copies and contact the relevant court or a solicitor about the evidence and procedure. Different routes apply if there is no valid will or no named executor can act. App access does not appoint a legal executor.

Check tax early. Obtain date-of-death balances and suitable valuations, identify debts and relevant gifts, and retain evidence. Check whether full HMRC reporting is required. Follow current forms, deadlines and payment instructions for the selected process; Scotland's stamped-C1 route differs from the England/Wales code and NI IHT421 routes.

Track notifications and remaining work. Recording an organization or sending a notification does not close an account. Check each provider's response and required steps. Stopping payment does not necessarily end a contract. Use Tell Us Once only where eligible and within the reference's validity period.

Protect assets and avoid premature distribution. Notify institutions and ask about their approved processes. Do not transact or distribute without the required authority. Obtaining a grant can be followed by substantial administration, including debts, taxes and claims.

Developer maintenance and additions checklist

1. Replace the categorical errors first, then verify all corresponding APK, demo and website text together. Re-check the Scottish IHT421/C1 wording in an actual reachable screen.

2. Maintain a content register: jurisdiction, author/source, checked date, applicable death dates, next review and owner. Version form changes independently of family notes.
3. Test each process choice with fictional valid-will, no-will, unavailable-executor, excepted/non-excepted and small-estate scenarios. Confirm that NI does not inherit an England/Wales-only court instruction.
4. Distinguish app roles, legal authority, document copies/originals and notification/closure states in labels and explanations. Keep one verified original-document custodian.
5. Add escalation paths and deadline reminders without claiming professional certification. Link to maintained authority/provider guidance rather than hardcoding changing fees, section numbers or waiting times.
6. Have suitably qualified jurisdictional reviewers assess the full reachable guidance, then test it with representative executors. Use synthetic examples and measure correct next actions and misunderstanding, not just visual polish.

For acceptance, retain evidence of the selected region, relevant death date and the actual screen reached. Check each reviewed correction against both an ordinary scenario and an exception. Screenshots of a successful happy path are insufficient to demonstrate a missing-will route, a rejected application or a policy-specific insurance decision. Record unresolved content questions separately from functional defects, and give every future amendment an accountable reviewer.

Reference guide

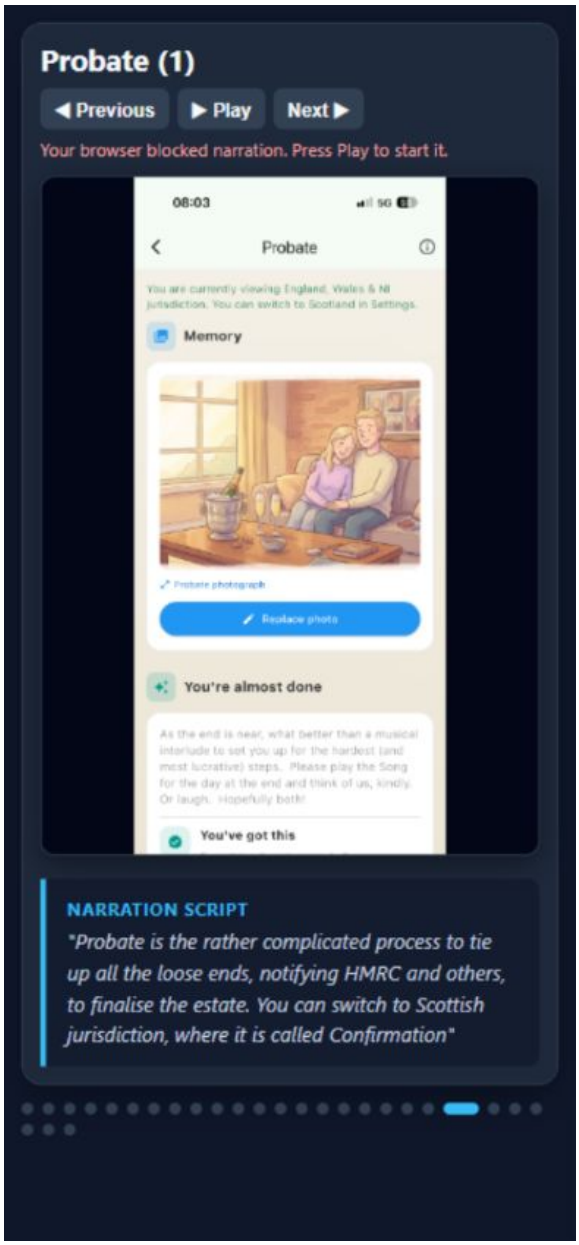
Primary links appear beside each finding. The principal maintained starting points are GOV.UK probate, NI probate, SCTS estates, HMRC IHT400, HMRC jurisdictional hand-offs, NRS registration, Tell Us Once, DVLA bereavement, Apple Legacy and FCA recurring payments.

Primary authorities and providers support the factual comparisons, not certification of this app. The 2016 Scottish practical guide remains linked by current official pages; it is used for general debt/distribution principles, not obsolete tax forms. No private will, property title, policy or provider contract was adjudicated. The public demo and its included images are evidence of the reviewed presentation; they are not a live execution of the supplied Android release.

Observed phone layout

Public demo at 390 by 844 CSS pixels

This is a browser screenshot of slide 21. The app interface is a raster picture inside the tour. The height cap leaves its detailed text miniature; the narration panel is readable. Clicking the picture did not open an enlarged view. The initial narration refusal is normal browser autoplay policy and clears after Play. This is evidence about the demo website, not an Android runtime screenshot.



The browser viewport override was reset after testing. The full control log is supplied separately as UnderCroft-demo-control-tests.csv.